she feared it might only cause more trouble.

“I think love is hope,” Rose said. “It helps you forget past sorrows.”

Léa softened again and squeezed her sister’s hand. “Whatever it is, I’m happy for you.”

“One day you’ll feel it, too.”

“No. Romantic love isn’t for me.”

“Don’t say that.” Rose looked pained. “You simply haven’t met the right man.”

“I’m not intent on meeting a man.” Léa sighed. “It’s work I need to find.”

“Do you know what André said?”

Léa could see her sister smiling in the moonlight. “Tell me.”

“He wants me to draw so that he can see the world through my eyes.”

“He’s right. You should draw; you have talent.”

“Thank you,” Rose said, squeezing Léa’s hand, “for listening.”

“Time to sleep. You’ve got an early start.”

Rose turned to the window. It didn’t take long before Léa heard her sister’s steady breathing—she’d fallen asleep.

But Léa couldn’t sleep. Rose was eighteen and in love. She was happy for her sister. And now, a part of Léa wished she could experience the feeling of being in love or being kissed. She did remember what it was to be eighteen—the sense that the world was a magical, wonderful place and the future bright. But then Maman died and Léa had to grow up fast. She’d lost that sense of wonder overnight. She wanted Rose to hold on to the feeling as long as possible, though. To do that, Léa had to find a job and a new place for them to live fast. October was less than a week away.